

HOLY CROSS PROCESSION

Presider and Ministers Draft

Sunday, September 13, 2026

Locations and Schedule

Time	Event	Location
8:30 am	Mass begins	Ss. Cyril & Methodius
9:30 am	Procession begins after Mass	New Jersey Avenue & N. 6th Street
10:00 am	Procession arrives and prayer service begins	St. Clement

Role Key

FR. PAUL	FR. NICK	DCN. JIM	ALL	LECTOR
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Prepared by Marcus Larsen • Revised September 1, 2026

Prayer service adapted from the Book of Blessings, "Order for the Blessing of a New Cross"

Scripture readings from the Lectionary for Mass

Psalms 22 from the Divine Office

Solemn blessing #5 from the Roman Missal

I. CONCLUSION OF MASS

After Communion

After Communion, the priest returns to the chair. Following the customary period of silence, he stands and says the Prayer after Communion. The assembly responds "Amen."

There is no final blessing or dismissal. The priest goes to the front of the altar. The deacon takes his place with the reliquary, and the thurifer and other ministers join them in front of the altar preparing to depart.

Announcement and invitation

In the following or similar words, the celebrant briefly addresses the faithful in order to prepare them for the celebration and to explain the meaning of the rite.

FR. PAUL	My dear brothers and sisters, we are here to commemorate the 1700th anniversary of the discovery of the True Cross. Let us venerate in faith the eternal plan by which God has made the cross of Christ the preeminent sign of his mercy. As we look upon the cross, let us call to mind that on it Christ brought to completion the sacrament of his love for the Church. As we bow before the cross, let us remember that in his own blood Christ has removed all division and out of the many nations created the one people of God. As we venerate the cross, let us reflect that we are ourselves Christ's disciples and must therefore follow him, willingly taking up our own cross each day. Let us, then, take part with all our hearts in this celebration, so that we may grasp the mystery of the cross more clearly and experience its power more deeply.
FR. PAUL	Let us pray.

All pray briefly in silence; then the celebrant continues:

FR. PAUL	Lord, your Son reconciled us to you by suffering on the cross and then returned to you in glory. May your people who honor the Cross of your Son as a sign of redemption find in it protection and strength; may they shoulder their own crosses in the spirit of the Gospel until their journey ends. We ask this through Christ our Lord.
ALL	Amen.
DCN. JIM	Let us proceed in peace.

Departure hymn

“Lift High the Cross” begins immediately. The thurifer leads the procession out; the deacon carries the reliquary; the priest follows in a position from which he can lead prayer; the faithful follow. Continue singing as the procession exits the church and forms on the sidewalk.

ALL	R/ Lift high the cross, the love of Christ proclaim till all the world adore His sacred name. 1. Led on their way by this triumphant sign, the hosts of God in conquering ranks combine. R/ 2. Each newborn servant of the Crucified bears on the brow the seal of Him who died. R/ 3. O Lord, once lifted on the glorious tree, as Thou hast promised, draw the world to Thee. R/ 4. So shall our song of triumph ever be: praise to the Crucified for victory! R/
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II. PRAYERS WHILE PROCESSING

Beginning

Once those who are participating in the procession have gathered outside and a suitable time has passed, the assembly continues walking and begins singing "The Royal Banners Forward Go" to the tune OLD HUNDREDTH.

ALL	1. The royal banners forward go, the cross shines forth redemption's flow; where He, by whom our flesh was made, our ransom in His flesh has paid. 2. Where deep for us the spear was dyed, life's torrent rushing from His side, to wash us in the precious flood where flowed the water and the blood.
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First Reading/Prayer

After the singing, the priest reads aloud the text taken from the Lectionary for the Mass:

FR. PAUL	A reading from the book of the Prophet Isaiah. <i>Isaiah 52:13-53:12</i>
FR. PAUL	See, my servant shall prosper, he shall be raised high and greatly exalted. Even as many were amazed at him-- so marred was his look beyond human semblance and his appearance beyond that of the sons of man-- so shall he startle many nations, because of him kings shall stand speechless; for those who have not been told shall see, those who have not heard shall ponder it. Who would believe what we have heard? To whom has the arm of the LORD been revealed? He grew up like a sapling before him,

like a shoot from the parched earth;
there was in him no stately bearing to make us look at him,
nor appearance that would attract us to him.
He was spurned and avoided by people,
a man of suffering, accustomed to infirmity,
one of those from whom people hide their faces,
spurned, and we held him in no esteem.

Yet it was our infirmities that he bore,
our sufferings that he endured,
while we thought of him as stricken,
as one smitten by God and afflicted.
But he was pierced for our offenses,
crushed for our sins;
upon him was the chastisement that makes us whole,
by his stripes we were healed.
We had all gone astray like sheep,
each following his own way;
but the LORD laid upon him
the guilt of us all.

Though he was harshly treated, he submitted
and opened not his mouth;
like a lamb led to the slaughter
or a sheep before the shearers,
he was silent and opened not his mouth.
Oppressed and condemned, he was taken away,
and who would have thought any more of his destiny?
When he was cut off from the land of the living,
and smitten for the sin of his people,
a grave was assigned him among the wicked
and a burial place with evildoers,
though he had done no wrong
nor spoken any falsehood.
But the LORD was pleased
to crush him in infirmity.

If he gives his life as an offering for sin,
he shall see his descendants in a long life,
and the will of the LORD shall be accomplished through
him.

	Because of his affliction he shall see the light in fullness of days; through his suffering, my servant shall justify many, and their guilt he shall bear. Therefore I will give him his portion among the great, and he shall divide the spoils with the mighty, because he surrendered himself to death and was counted among the wicked; and he shall take away the sins of many, and win pardon for their offenses.
FR. PAUL	The word of the Lord.
ALL	Thanks be to God.

A period of silence follows the reading of the word of God.

Hymn

Once a suitable time has passed, the assembly continues walking and sings the next verses of "The Royal Banners Forward Go" to the tune OLD HUNDREDTH.

ALL	3. Fulfilled is all that David told in sure prophetic song of old: that God the nations' King should be and reign in triumph from the tree. 4. On whose hard arms, so widely flung, the weight of this world's ransom hung, the price of humankind to pay and spoil the spoiler of his prey.
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Second Reading/Prayer

After the singing, the priest reads aloud the Psalm text taken from the Divine Office:

FR. PAUL

My God, my God, why have you forsaken me?
You are far from my plea and the cry of my distress.
O my God, I call by day and you give no reply;
I call by night and I find no peace.

Yet you, O God, are holy,
enthroned on the praises of Israel.
In you our fathers put their trust;
they trusted and you set them free.
When they cried to you, they escaped.
In you they trusted and never in vain.

But I am a worm and no man,
scorned by men, despised by the people.
All who see me deride me.
They curl their lips, they toss their heads.
“He trusted in the Lord, let him save him;
let him release him if this is his friend.”

Yes, it was you who took me from the womb,
entrusted me to my mother’s breast.
To you I was committed from my birth,
from my mother’s womb you have been my God.
Do not leave me alone in my distress;
come close, there is none else to help.

Many bulls have surrounded me,
fierce bulls of Bashan close me in.
Against me they open wide their jaws,
like lions, rending and roaring.

Like water I am poured out,
disjointed are all my bones.
My heart has become like wax,
it is melted within my breast.

Parched as burnt clay is my throat,
my tongue cleaves to my jaws.

Many dogs have surrounded me,
a band of the wicked beset me.
They tear holes in my hands and my feet
and lay me in the dust of death.

I can count every one of my bones.
These people stare at me and gloat;
they divide my clothing among them.
They cast lots for my robe.

O Lord, do not leave me alone,
my strength, make haste to help me!
Rescue my soul from the sword,
my life from the grip of these dogs.
Save my life from the jaws of these lions,
my poor soul from the horns of these oxen.

I will tell of your name to my brethren
and praise you where they are assembled.

"You who fear the Lord, give him praise;
all sons of Jacob, give him glory.
Revere him, Israel's sons.

For he has never despised
nor scorned the poverty of the poor.
From him he has not hidden his face,
but he heard the poor man when he cried."

You are my praise in the great assembly.
My vows I will pay before those who fear him.
The poor shall eat and shall have their fill.
They shall praise the Lord, those who seek him.
May their hearts live for ever and ever!

All the earth shall remember and return to the Lord,
all families of the nations worship before him
for the kingdom is the Lord's; he is the ruler of the nations.
They shall worship him, all the mighty of the earth;

	before him shall bow all who go down to the dust. And my soul shall live for him, my children serve him. They shall tell of the Lord to the generations yet to come, declare his faithfulness to peoples yet unborn: “These things the Lord has done.”
FR. PAUL	Glory to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit.
ALL	As it was in the beginning, is now, and will be forever. Amen.

A period of silence follows the reading of the word of God.

Hymn

Once a suitable time has passed, the assembly continues walking and sings the next verses of “The Royal Banners Forward Go” to the tune OLD HUNDREDTH.

ALL	5. Blest tree, whose chosen branches bore the wealth that did the world restore, thy wood became the scales that weighed the ransom Christ in mercy paid. 6. O tree of beauty, tree most fair, ordained those holy limbs to bear; gone is thy shame, each crimson bough proclaims the King of glory now.
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Third Reading/Prayer

After the singing, the priest reads aloud the text taken from the Lectionary for the Mass:

FR. PAUL	A reading from the first letter of St. Paul to the Corinthians. <i>I Corinthians 1:17-2:5</i>
FR. PAUL	Brothers and sisters: Christ did not send me to baptize but to preach the Gospel, and not with the wisdom of human eloquence, so that the cross of Christ might not be emptied of its meaning.

The message of the cross is foolishness to those who are perishing,
but to us who are being saved it is the power of God.
For it is written:

*I will destroy the wisdom of the wise,
and the learning of the learned I will set aside.*

Where is the wise one?

Where is the scribe?

Where is the debater of this age?

Has not God made the wisdom of the world foolish?

For since in the wisdom of God

the world did not come to know God through wisdom,

it was the will of God through the foolishness of the proclamation
to save those who have faith.

For Jews demand signs and Greeks look for wisdom,
but we proclaim Christ crucified,

a stumbling block to Jews and foolishness to Gentiles,

but to those who are called, Jews and Greeks alike,

Christ the power of God and the wisdom of God.

For the foolishness of God is wiser than human wisdom,

and the weakness of God is stronger than human strength.

Consider your own calling, brothers and sisters.

Not many of you were wise by human standards,

not many were powerful,

not many were of noble birth.

Rather, God chose the foolish of the world to shame the wise,

and God chose the weak of the world to shame the strong,

and God chose the lowly and despised of the world,

those who count for nothing,

to reduce to nothing those who are something,

so that no human being might boast before God.

It is due to him that you are in Christ Jesus,

who became for us wisdom from God,

as well as righteousness, sanctification, and redemption,

so that, as it is written,

"Whoever boasts, should boast in the Lord."

When I came to you, brothers and sisters,

proclaiming the mystery of God,

	I did not come with sublimity of words or of wisdom. For I resolved to know nothing while I was with you except Jesus Christ, and him crucified. I came to you in weakness and fear and much trembling, and my message and my proclamation were not with persuasive words of wisdom, but with a demonstration of Spirit and power, so that your faith might rest not on human wisdom but on the power of God.
FR. PAUL	The word of the Lord.
ALL	Thanks be to God.

A period of silence follows the reading of the word of God.

Hymn

Once a suitable time has passed, the assembly continues walking and sings the final verses of "The Royal Banners Forward Go" to the tune OLD HUNDREDTH.

ALL	7. O cross, on which in mortal strife was slain the Author of all life where Life Himself His death endured that life from death might be procured. 8. Eternal holy Trinity, let all our praises rise to Thee; as by the cross Thou dost restore, so guide and keep us evermore.
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If the procession has not yet reached its destination, a period of sustained, prayerful silence may remain.

III. PRAYER SERVICE & VENERATION

Entrance and Placement of the Relic

“Lift High the Cross” begins once the procession enters. The deacon carries the reliquary to the prepared table and places it there. The thurifer and ministers take their assigned places. Allow the entire assembly to enter and settle. The hymn ends.

ALL	R/ Lift high the cross, the love of Christ proclaim till all the world adore His sacred name. 1. Led on their way by this triumphant sign, the hosts of God in conquering ranks combine. R/ 2. Each newborn servant of the Crucified bears on the brow the seal of Him who died. R/ 3. O Lord, once lifted on the glorious tree, as Thou hast promised, draw the world to Thee. R/ 4. So shall our song of triumph ever be: praise to the Crucified for victory! R/
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Reading of the Word of God

There is no invocation, greeting, or opening prayer. The reader goes directly to the ambo and begins the reading.

LECTOR	A reading from the letter of St. Paul to the Philippians. <i>Philippians 2:6-11</i>
LECTOR	Christ Jesus, though he was in the form of God, did not regard equality with God something to be grasped. Rather, he emptied himself, taking the form of a slave, coming in human likeness;

	and found human in appearance, he humbled himself, becoming obedient to the point of death, even death on a cross. Because of this, God greatly exalted him and bestowed on him the name which is above every name, that at the name of Jesus every knee should bend, of those in heaven and on earth and under the earth, and every tongue confess that Jesus Christ is Lord, to the glory of God the Father.
LECTOR	The word of the Lord.
ALL	Thanks be to God.

Homily

As circumstances suggest, the celebrant may give those present a brief explanation of the biblical text, so that they may understand through faith the meaning of the celebration.

Prayer before the Relic

After the homily, the celebrant, standing before the cross and with hands outstretched, says the prayer of blessing.

FR. NICK	Blessed are you, Lord God, Father all-holy, for your boundless love. The tree, once the source of shame and death for humankind, has become the cross of our redemption and life. When his hour had come to return to you in glory, the Lord Jesus, our King, our Priest, and our Teacher, freely mounted the scaffold of the cross and made it his royal throne,
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	his altar of sacrifice, his pulpit of truth. On the cross, lifted above the earth, he triumphed over our age-old enemy. Cloaked in his own blood, he drew all things to himself. On the cross, he opened out his arms and offered you his life: the sacrifice of the New Law that gives to the sacraments their saving power. On the cross, he proved what he had prophesied: the grain of wheat must die to bring forth an abundant harvest. Father, we honor this cross as the sign of our redemption. May we reap the harvest of salvation planted in pain by Christ Jesus. May our sins be nailed to his cross, the power of life released, pride conquered, and weakness turned to strength. May the cross be our comfort in trouble, our refuge in the face of danger, our safeguard on life's journey, until you welcome us to our heavenly home. Grant this through Christ our Lord.
ALL	Amen.

Incensation and Veneration

Then the celebrant places incense in the censer and incenses the cross. After this, one of the following antiphons or some other song in honor of the cross is sung.

During the hymn, all go up to venerate the relic. The celebrant and ministers venerate first. The faithful then approach in an orderly manner and offer a sign of reverence.

ALL	1. Faithful cross, true sign of triumph, be for us the noblest tree; none in foliage, none in blossom, none in fruit thine equal be; symbol of the world's redemption, for the weight that hung on thee! 2. Bend thy boughs, O tree of glory! Thy relaxing sinews bend; for a while the ancient rigor that thy birth bestowed, suspend; and the King of heav'nly beauty on thy bosom gently tend! 3. Thou alone wast counted worthy this world's ransom to sustain, that a shipwrecked race forever might a port of refuge gain, with the sacred blood anointed of the Lamb of sinners slain. 4. To the Trinity be glory everlasting, as is meet; equal to the Father, equal to the Son, and Paraclete; God the three-in-one, whose praises all created things repeat.
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Intercessions

The veneration of the cross is followed by intercessions, either in the form usual at Mass or in the form given here. The celebrant says:

FR. NICK	Let us pray with confidence to Christ, who has redeemed us by his cross, as we say:
ALL	By the power of your cross, save us, O Lord.
DCN. JIM	Christ Jesus, you emptied yourself, taking the form of a servant and being made like us; grant that your people may follow the example of your humility. (For this we pray:)
ALL	By the power of your cross, save us, O Lord.
DCN. JIM	Christ Jesus, you humbled yourself and became obedient unto death, even death on a cross; grant that your servants may imitate your obedience and patient endurance of trials. (For this we pray:)
ALL	By the power of your cross, save us, O Lord.
DCN. JIM	Christ Jesus, you were raised up by the Father and given the name that is above all names; may your people persevere in your service to the end. (For this we pray:)
ALL	By the power of your cross, save us, O Lord.
DCN. JIM	Christ Jesus, at your name every knee, in heaven, on earth, and under the earth, will bend in adoration; draw all people to your heart so that they will honor and adore you in faith. (For this we pray:)
ALL	By the power of your cross, save us, O Lord.
DCN. JIM	Christ Jesus, every tongue shall proclaim to the glory of the Father: Jesus Christ is Lord; welcome our brothers and sisters who have died into the unfailing joy of your kingdom. (For this we pray:)
ALL	By the power of your cross, save us, O Lord.

Lord's Prayer

In the following or similar words, the celebrant invites all present to sing or say the Lord's prayer.

FR. NICK	We have remembered the words and example of our Lord in his passion: in faith let us surrender ourselves as he did to the will of the Father, using the words our Savior taught us.
ALL	Our Father, who art in heaven, hallowed be thy name; thy kingdom come, thy will be done on earth as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread, and forgive us our trespasses, as we forgive those who trespass against us; and lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil. Amen.

Concluding Prayer and Solemn Blessing

The celebrant immediately continues:

FR. NICK	O God, to save the whole human race you allowed your Son to undergo the agony of the cross. Listen kindly to our prayer, that we who on earth confess the mystery of your redemption may in heaven receive the glorious reward won by our redeemer. We ask this through Christ our Lord.
ALL	Amen.

After the concluding prayer, the deacon invites the assembly to bow for the solemn blessing.

DCN. JIM	Bow down for the blessing.
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The celebrant extends his hands over the people.

FR. NICK	May God, the Father of mercies, who has given you an example of love in the Passion of his Only Begotten Son, grant that, by serving God and your neighbor, you may lay hold of the wondrous gift of his blessing.
ALL	Amen.
FR. NICK	So that you may receive the reward of everlasting life from him, through whose earthly Death you believe that you escape eternal death.
ALL	Amen.
FR. NICK	And by following the example of his self-abasement, may you possess a share in his Resurrection.
ALL	Amen.
FR. NICK	And may the blessing of almighty God, the Father, + and the Son, and the Holy Spirit, come down on you and remain with you for ever.
ALL	Amen.

All depart. There is no separate dismissal formula.